the Commission but was overruled by the Viceroy, Lord Reading, who maintained that there should be at least one member from the Indian school of thought who favoured the 1s 4d rate.[5] This example of fairness impressed Purshotamdas, who often found himself at odds with the government but was a strong admirer of the British character. He once confided in a friend, 'I am for the British connection because no other set of people endowed with power have the same substratum of fair play. To deal with them is therefore no losing game.'[6] This faith was somewhat shaken by the devious expedients resorted to by his British colleagues in London, to prevent his now famous Minute of dissent from marring the unanimity of the Hilton Young Commission's report. Yet he remained by and large an admirer of what he perceived to be the British sense of fair play.

The India Office had also opposed Purshotamdas's nomination to the Commission, citing impartiality and the absence of deep commitment to any particular position or opinion. Since control over the Indian members was of vital importance, they had to be chosen with care. Purshotamdas held strong views on the subjects which the Commission was to examine; and his record of opposition to the government's post-war currency and exchange policies had done nothing to endear him to Whitehall. But Purshotamdas had played an important role in the debates in and outside the Central Legislature, and a Commission without him would have little credibility in India. It was thought that the other three Indian members were selected largely to balance Purshotamdas's views and influence.[7] G. Balachandran observes that nominations to such commissions were usually of persons whose views resembled those of the appointing authority. He says that the neutral disinterested expert pondering his subject from the standpoint of theory, accepted practice, and public interest was difficult to find.

Though Purshotamdas's selection was generally welcomed, a section of the IMC—people like L.R. Tairsee and K.T. Shah—argued that given the composition of the Commission, (packed as it was with members who toed the government's line), the IMC should boycott it and Purshotamdas should resign. Purshotamdas however refused saying that it was at great cost to himself and his business that he had accepted the 'call of duty towards my country.'[8] He also pointed out that the recommendations of various commissions which Indians had boycotted due to the Non-cooperation